

SKILLS GUIDE



Excellent interpersonal skills to communicate with choreographers and other dancers about routines.



The ability to work in a team with a troupe of dancers, choreographers, and others.



An ability to master new types of dance and to meet the demands of an ongoing performance.



A high level of physical fitness and stamina to brave the rigorous cycles of training and performance.



Creativity to add individuality to choreography, and an innate sense of rhythm, timing, and musicality.



Motivation and the self-discipline to train and rehearse regularly, and maintain high levels of fitness.



DANCE TEACHER Trains students of all ages in different types of dance. Dance teachers work in dance and stage schools, as well as colleges, and may also teach related subjects, such as drama or performing arts.



CHOREOGRAPHER Works in theater, film, and television to create routines for dancers and other performers. Planning movements to fit the music and staging, choreographers need to work closely with musical directors and costume designers.

RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **MUSICIAN** *see pp. 38–39*
- ▶ **ACTOR** *see pp. 42–43*
- ▶ **ARTS ADMINISTRATOR** Plans and oversees programs of arts activities and events in theaters, museums, galleries, and music festivals. This may be a new career for dancers who have retired from performance.
- ▶ **CHILDREN'S ENTERTAINER** Provides shows and entertainment for children at parties, cruise ships, or family-centered hotels. Jobs can be sporadic or seasonal, and most entertainers have another line of work to supplement their income.

AT A GLANCE



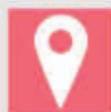
YOUR INTERESTS Dance • Music • Drama • Art • Mime • Musical theater • Self-expression • Fitness and sports



ENTRY QUALIFICATIONS Training at a stage school, dance academy, or ballet school is essential. A degree in dance and choreography may help.



LIFESTYLE Working hours can be long and dancers may have to rehearse and tour a lot. Keeping fit is crucial because the job is physically demanding.



LOCATION Dancers work in film and TV studios, as well as in opera, theaters, nightclubs, hotels, festivals, and on cruise ships. They may have to travel.



THE REALITIES Gigs may be irregular. Self-confidence to continue pursuing your goals is important when facing rejections at auditions.